

# Acme Retail — Refund and Returns Policy

Effective 2024 | Customer Operations

## 1. Overview

This policy describes how Acme Retail handles customer returns and refunds across all sales channels. The policy applies uniformly to direct purchases, marketplace purchases, and bulk orders, except where specific sections below state otherwise.

Customers are encouraged to review this policy in full before initiating any return request. Many situations that appear straightforward have category-specific rules described in sections 3 through 5.

## 2. Standard returns

For standard catalog items, customers may return unused products within 30 days of delivery for a full refund. The item must be in its original packaging with all accessories and documentation included. Refunds are issued to the original payment method within 7 business days of the returned item being received at the warehouse.

Items returned in damaged or worn condition due to customer handling may be assessed a restocking fee of up to 25 percent of the purchase price. The fee is communicated to the customer before the refund is processed, and the customer may decline the return and have the item shipped back at their cost.

Returns initiated after the 30-day window are evaluated case by case and are not guaranteed. Customers should contact support with their order number and reason for the late return.

## 3. Custom or personalized orders

Custom-made and personalized items are generally not eligible for return or refund. This includes engraved products, made-to-measure apparel, and any item where the customer specified non-standard dimensions, materials, or finishes during the order process.

However, if a custom item arrives damaged or defective, customers should follow the defective items process described in section 4 below. The standard 30-day window does not apply to damaged custom items, but the customer must report the damage within 7 days of delivery for the claim to be valid. Returns of custom items for any other reason (change of mind, sizing issues that meet specification) are not accepted.

## 4. Defective and damaged items

Items that arrive damaged in transit, or that fail within the manufacturer warranty period, qualify for replacement or full refund at the customer's choice. Customers must report damage with photographic evidence within 14 days of delivery. After 14 days, the manufacturer warranty process applies and Acme Retail's role is limited to facilitation.

Defective items do not need to be returned in original packaging. A prepaid return shipping label is provided once the claim is approved. For high-value items (over 500 dollars), the refund is issued upon return, not before.

If the original item is no longer in stock when a replacement is requested, customers may select a comparable item of equal or lesser value, or receive a full refund.

## **5. Bulk and corporate orders**

Bulk orders (quantities above 50 of any single SKU) are governed by the terms of the customer's corporate purchase agreement. The standard 30-day window does not automatically apply. Bulk return requests must be coordinated with a corporate account representative.

Custom configurations on bulk orders follow the same rules as section 3: not returnable except for damage or defect, and damage must be reported within 7 days of delivery.

## **6. Refund processing times**

Refunds to credit and debit cards typically post within 3 to 7 business days from the date the refund is issued by Acme Retail. Refunds to bank transfers and corporate accounts may take 5 to 10 business days. Acme Retail does not control the timing once the refund is issued by our payments processor.

Customers experiencing refund delays beyond 14 business days should contact their card issuer first, then escalate to Acme support with the refund confirmation number provided in the original return email.